

Virtual Diablo 630 Printer

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This device accepts text and ESC sequences for a Diablo 630 Printer, or one of it's clones, and produces PostScript output to a file. Through the use of "job end" actions, that output may be printed or otherwise handled.

Properties (or parameters) are:

diablo630_cpi

(or "cpi=") The default CPI setting, either 10, 12, or 15.

diablo630_lpi

(or "lpi=") The default (initial) LPI setting, either 6 or 8.

diablo630_font

(or "font=", comma-separated) The default (initial) Font to use. Syntax is

Name Style Size

(or "Name,Style,Size") Where "Name" is a valid string for the host computer's installed fonts. Also accepts Java generic fonts such as "Monospaced". "Style" is things like "PLAIN". "Size" is the point size, typically things like "12" for 10 cpi printing.

diablo630_alt_color

(or "alt_color=") The alternate color to use instead of RED for two-color printing. A 6-digit hexadecimal number representing the RGB color. Default is ff0000 or RED.

diablo630_paper

(or "paper=", comma-separated) The default (initial) Paper to use. Syntax is

Param Param...

(or "param,param...") Where params are some meaningful combination of:

LETTER

U.S. Letter sized paper, 8.5x11

LEGAL

U.S. Legal sized paper, 8.5x14

A4

ISO A4 sized paper, 210x297mm

FORMS

Legacy large forms sized paper, 11x14, typically used LANDSCAPE

PORTRAIT

Portrait orientation

LANDSCAPE

Landscape orientation

Other media sizes may be selected from the "Paper" option in the "Settings" menu.

diablo630_file

(or "file=") The initial file to use for output. Especially handy when used as a parameter for multiple printers on a server, to ensure each has a unique and separate output file.

diablo630_nogui

(or "nogui") Do not create/display the printer control console. Useful for CP/Net server applications, especially if multiple printers are being created.

diablo630_jobend

The action to take when a job ends (e.g. ENDLIST.COM is run). The can only be set in a configuration (properties) file. Value syntax is one or more of:

DISCARD

Throw away output and start next job with empty file. Not terribly useful.

SAVE [*pattern*]

Rename file to a "unique" name. Default filename pattern is "jobYYYYMMDDHHMMSS.S.ps", where the upper-case letters represent the digits of the current date and time (down to milliseconds). The *pattern* may contain substitution tags as follows:

- %x** Use built-in temporary file creation. All other tags are ignored.
- %j** Job ID. Resets back to "1" whenever JAR is started.
- %s** Timestamp as in default.
- %t** Time in the form HHMMSS.S.
- %d** Date in the form YYYYMMDD.

If more actions follow, *pattern* must be "--" to choose default.

QUEUE *command*...

Execute *command*, presumably to queue the output to a printer. The command is scanned for "%f" which will be replaced with the current output file name. The output will be discarded after the command completes. This command should not produce any stdout or stderr output, and should return promptly (i.e. be well-behaved). Typical command for a Linux system with CUPS, and having a default printer set, might be "lpr %f". The printer queue must be capable of (possibly using special options) processing PostScript. No special shell syntax is allowed, such as redirection, variable substitution, or quoting. The command itself, though, may be a shell script (for example, a wrapper around some more complex command).

If more actions follow, *command*... must end with "--".

If both **SAVE** and **QUEUE** are specified, the job will be renamed first and then the queue command run on the saved file name.

If conflicting actions are assigned (e.g. **DISCARD** and **SAVE**), results are unspecified.